

COMPLAINT NO. 2023-00216

IN THE MATTER OF

PATIENCE SIMMS

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**BEFORE THE TEXAS BEHAVIORAL
HEALTH EXECUTIVE COUNCIL**

**THE TEXAS STATE BOARD
OF EXAMINERS OF
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELORS**

AGREED ORDER

Pursuant to its authority under §507.305 of the Texas Occupations Code, §2001.056 of the Government Code, and 22 Texas Administrative Code §884.12(e), the Executive Director for the Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council (“Council”) hereby approves, ratifies, and enters this Agreed Order with the following Findings of Fact, Conclusions of Law, and Order of Council, which have been approved and accepted by **PATIENCE SIMMS** (“Respondent”) and which constitutes a full settlement and compromise of the complaint(s) currently pending against Respondent before the Council in the above-referenced and numbered matter(s).

FINDINGS OF FACT

1. Respondent is licensed as a Professional Counselor Associate (#85700) in the State of Texas and is, therefore, subject to the jurisdiction of the Council.
2. Respondent did violate a court order by not assigning costs to her clients in keeping with the order.

CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

1. Respondent voluntarily received a license from the Council and, therefore, is bound by the provisions of Chapters 503 and 507 of the Texas Occupations Code and the Rules of the Council, 22 Texas Administrative Code Parts 30 and 41.
2. Violation of the Council’s Rules is unprofessional conduct and constitutes grounds for the imposition of sanctions under §§503.401, 507.301, and 507.351 of the Texas Occupations Code.
3. Based on the above Findings of Fact, the Council finds that Respondent violated Council Rules 22 TAC §681.41(v) regarding General Ethical Requirements.

ORDER

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, ADJUDGED, AND DECREED THAT:

4. Respondent's license is hereby REPRIMANDED.
5. Respondent, within thirty (60) days of the date this order is ratified, shall complete and submit proof of completion of six (6) hours of professional development relating to ethics and legal documents and six (6) hours of professional development relating to accurate and complete recordkeeping regard clients. This professional development is in addition to the professional development hours required for license renewal. Respondent will pay all costs of the coursework.

WARNING

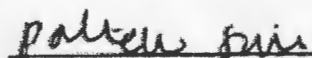
RESPONDENT'S FAILURE TO COMPLY WITH ONE OR MORE TERMS OF THIS ORDER MAY CONSTITUTE A VIOLATION OF 22 TEXAS ADMINISTRATIVE CODE §884.55 REQUIRING FURTHER DISCIPLINARY ACTION.

WAIVERS

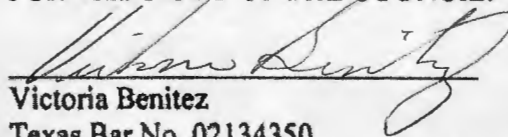
On the underlying investigative file, Respondent has waived his or her right to an informal settlement conference, a formal hearing before an Administrative Law Judge at the State Office of Administrative Hearings (SOAH), and judicial review pursuant to Texas Government Code Chapter 2001, in exchange for the conditions set out in this Agreed Order.

THE RESPONDENT, BY SIGNING THIS ORDER, AGREES TO ITS TERMS, ACKNOWLEDGES UNDERSTANDING OF THE FORMAL NOTICES, FINDINGS OF FACT, AND CONCLUSIONS OF LAW SET FORTH HEREIN AND COVENANTS TO SATISFACTORILY COMPLY WITH THE MANDATES OF THIS ORDER IN A TIMELY MANNER. RESPONDENT FURTHER ACKNOWLEDGES AND AGREES THAT HE OR SHE HAS AGREED TO THIS ORDER UPON THE ADVICE AND CONSENT OF COUNSEL, OR THAT HE OR SHE HAS HAD THE OPPORTUNITY TO HAVE THIS ORDER REVIEWED BY COUNSEL OF HIS OR HER CHOICE.

FOR THE RESPONDENT:


Patience Simms
Professional Counselor Associate
#85700

FOR THE STAFF OF THE COUNCIL:


Victoria Benitez
Texas Bar No. 02134350
Staff Attorney, BHEC
1801 Congress Ave., Ste. 7.300
Austin, Texas 70701

DATE SIGNED: 8/20/24

L. Clement

Laurel Clement
atty for Respondent

DATE SIGNED: 8-21-24

APPROVED, RATIFIED, AND ENTERED THIS 21th DAY OF August, 2024.

Darrel Spinks

Darrel Spinks
Executive Director
Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council